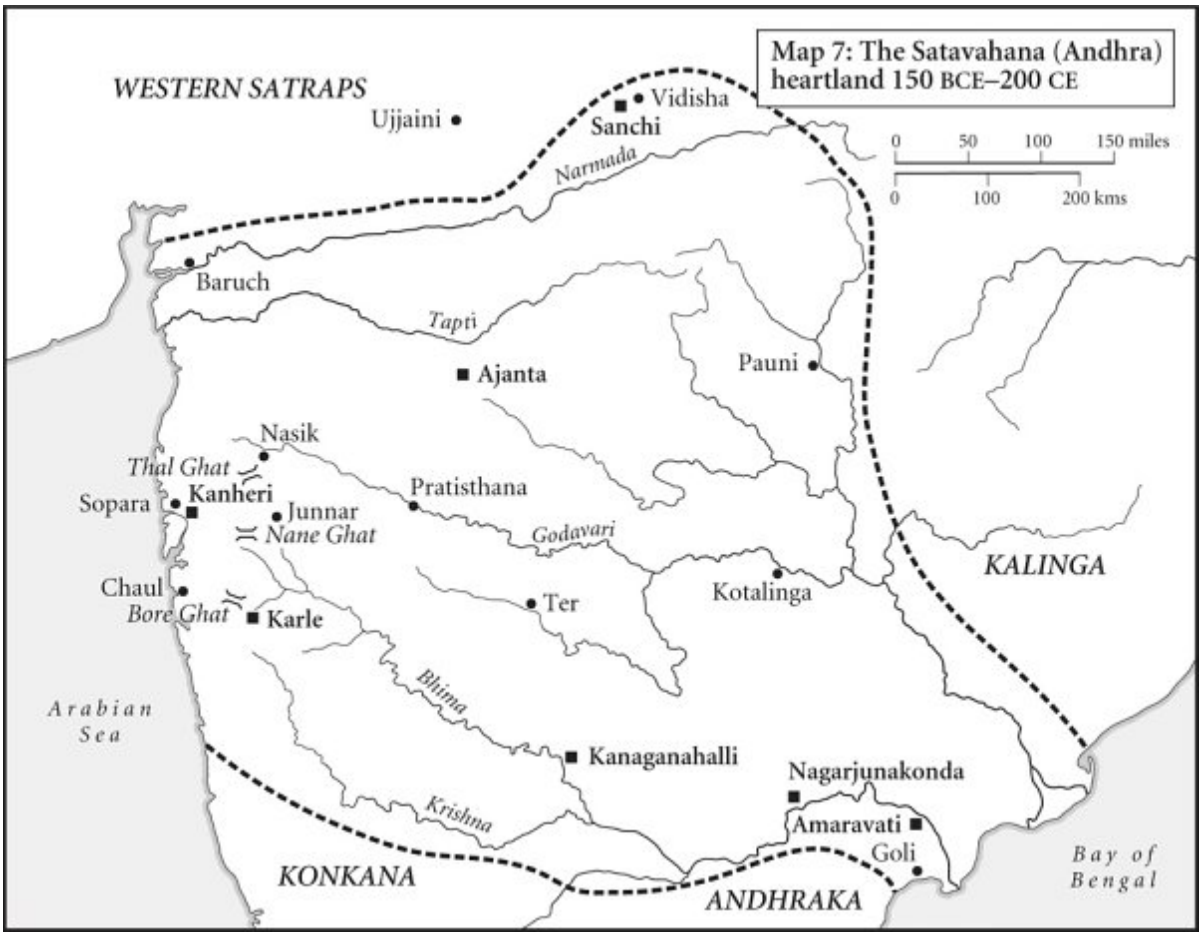


The Satavahana empire at its height, showing major trade centres (marked ●), main passes (marked ⩛), major Buddhist rock-cut caves and main Buddhist stupa sites (marked ■).

Two thousand years ago Pratisthana was important enough for the early Graeco-Roman shipping guide known as the *Periplus Maris Erythraei*, or 'Voyage round the Erythraean [i.e. Arabian] Sea', to declare it, as 'Paethana', to be one of the two most important trading centres of the Deccan, the other being 'Tagara':

> Among the market towns of Dachinabades, for *dachanos* [i.e. Dakshina, Deccan] in the languages of the natives means 'south', there are two of special importance: Paethana, about twenty days' journey south from Barygaza [the modern Broach], beyond which, about ten days' journey east, there is another